BLINK

player aid · every stage, every choice

rules v0.26

THE ROUND

six beats · the table finishes each one before the next

1 LAY
everyone lays a meld FACE DOWN
leader first, then clockwise

2 REVEAL
turn them all over together
one beat, all at once

3 DECLARE
spend a victory card on its A effect, or not
leader first — you can see every meld

4 RANK
highest total wins the trick
ties broken in order — see below

5 SETTLE
set your initiative markers, pay the trick's dues
the black marker is always 1, then 2, 3 and 4

6 MAP
spend your remaining meld, winner first
every card left is already yours to spend

Ties: more cards, a tie-winning A, the higher victory card spent on A, highest card, earliest laid.

Held as many cards as the trick's winner, or more, and lost? Shed cards one at a time until below that count: each one pays 1 gold instead of acting, into your own discard. Last place pays you +1 gold.

Hand empty and meld spent? Recycle at once, mid-turn — the back of this sheet says what that means.

WHAT MAY I LAY?

one meld, face down, every round

ANY UNBROKEN RUN of ranks · duplicates free · suits irrelevant · up to your tier's MELD limit

✓ **2-3-3-4-4** ✗ 2-2-4-4 (no 3)

highest TOTAL takes the trick — not the longest meld

WHAT ARE MY OPTIONS?

what a card, a coin and a victory card can do

A CARD IN YOUR MELD

does ONE of —

- **SETTLE** — a unit from your top tier
- **EXPLORE** — a new tile of the card's suit · must touch TWO tiles
- **ATTACK** — a duel · your rank vs card + ground · take it: +1 gold
- **CASH** — 1 gold

Every card: IN REACH — a tile you hold or one beside it — and its SUIT MATCHES THE GROUND.

A COIN

buys one of —

- **RESEARCH** 1 then 2 — retire your lowest · take a card up to your rank cap, to hand or discard
- **TRADE** 1 then 2 — draw the market's top two, blind · bury any two back
- **FORTIFY** 1 — on a unit: defends at WALL + terrain until a fight or a move
- **KEEP** – — gold breaks a tie at the end

research or trade: two a turn, 1 gold then 2

A VICTORY-ROW CARD

spend it on ONE of —

- **A** in the DECLARE step — add its rank to your meld's total this trick
- **B** in your map phase — found a colony — new tiles and units from the supply
- **C** in your map phase — take 2–5 gold, by its rank band

THEN IT LEAVES THE ROW
– 1 point · your centre card may drop. It goes to the BOTTOM of the market: nothing leaves the game.

WHAT A, B AND C ARE WORTH

by the rank of the card you spend

RANK	A · the trick	B · the map	C · gold
1–5	+ its rank	colony, this suit	2g
6–10	+ its rank · wins ties	colony, up to 2 out	3g
11–15	+ its rank	2 tiles, 1 unit	4g
16–20	+ its rank · wins ties	2 colonies, any terrain	5g

A is declared AFTER every meld is face up, leader first. One effect per player per round.

TURN OVER for where your cards go, the recycle, and what the map scores.

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the card loop · the recycle · what the map scores

rules v0.26

WHERE YOUR CARDS GO

almost nothing leaves the game

YOUR HAND
ten cards
always ten — nothing you play leaves you

→

YOUR MELD
face down, then up
what you lay for the trick

→

THE MAP
settle · explore · attack
or cash it for 1 gold

→

YOUR DISCARD
face up on your board
everything you spent this cycle

→

RECYCLE
your discard IS your new hand
ten cards · nothing you play ever leaves you

A victory card you spend	leaves the row — to the MARKET
A card bumped from a full row	to the MARKET as well · trade draws from it
Lost with as many cards as the winner, or more	set cards aside to below their count — into YOUR discard, +1 gold each

THE RECYCLE

the moment your hand is empty and your meld spent

WHEN
`hand empty, meld spent`
at once, mid-turn — finish your turn after

→

1 · INCOME
`with objectives`
1 gold per objective you hold right now, shown or hidden

→

2 · PICK UP
`always`
take your discard back — that IS your ten · nothing is drawn

You never draw cards to refill: the cards you spent are the cards you pick up.

MAP OBJECTIVES

the only points about the SHAPE of what you hold

SHOW ONE, KEEP ONE · both score

three tiles you occupy: a MIDDLE terrain with one named terrain on either side of it

the two ends need not touch each other — a bend counts exactly as a straight line

two each, dealt AFTER the starting map is laid

2 points for every arrangement you hold at the end

build it twice and it pays twice: each MIDDLE tile pays once, and an end may serve two middles

the card you show tells the table which single tile would break it

INCOME

`at each recycle`

1 GOLD PER OBJECTIVE
at each recycle, for each of your two cards whose pattern you hold right now — shown or hidden

FLAT
one coin per card, however many arrangements it has

POINTS STILL COUNT
income is paid at the recycle; the points are counted at the end

FREE

no card · any order · on your own turn

MOVE `1 per meld card`
land: through your own tiles · sea: across empty Ocean · never an attack.

WATER `once a turn`
sail onto a new Ocean tile laid on your water's coast.

RESEARCH · FORTIFY
both cost coins — priced in full on the front, under A COIN. COLONY is effect B, in the victory-row column.

THE GROUND

what each terrain holds, and what it is worth to defend

Plains	**Forest**	**Ocean**	**Mountain**
holds 3	2 · +1 defence	1 · sea road	1 · +2 defence